

RESEARCH METHOD-I

Semester-V

APSY-356

(2021-2025)

Grounded Theory Methodology

Subaha Faisal-44(Leader)

Laiba Shamshad-15

Muskan Shafqat-32

Eman Fatima-33

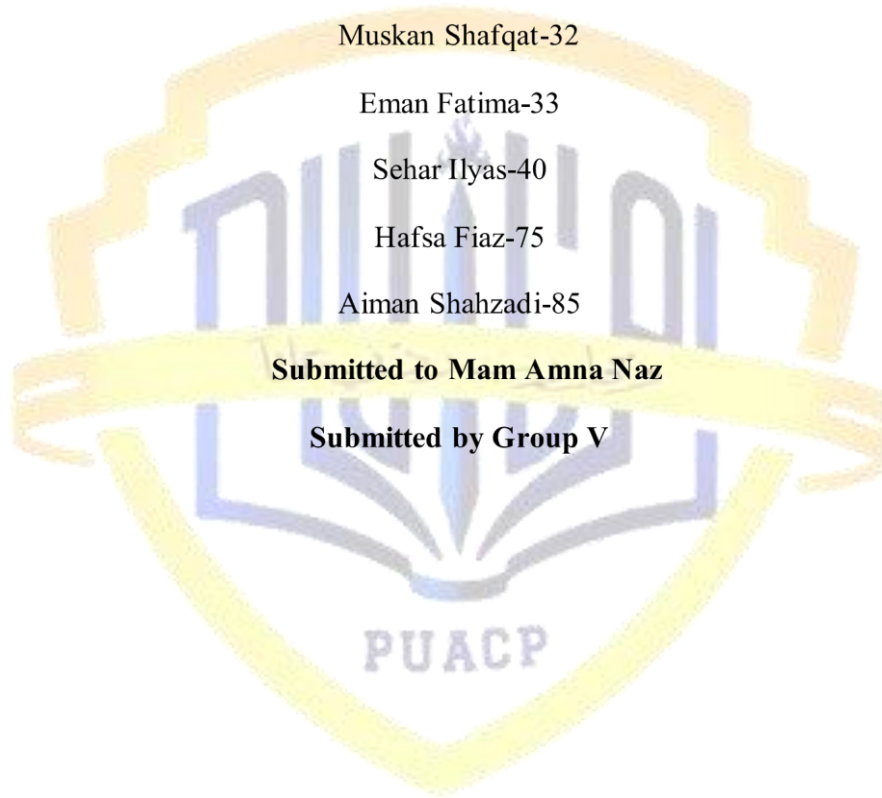
Sehar Ilyas-40

Hafsa Fiaz-75

Aiman Shahzadi-85

Submitted to Mam Amna Naz

Submitted by Group V



Grounded Group Methodology

The grounded theory approach is a qualitative research methodology that attempts to unravel the meanings of people's interactions, social actions, and experiences. In other words, these explanations are grounded in the participants' own interpretations or explanations.

Founders

The original version of grounded theory was outlined by **Barney Glaser and Anselm Strauss** in **1967** in their book, *The Discovery of Grounded Theory*.

Basic Purpose

- Grounded theory (GT) is a research method concerned with the **generation of theory** or the development of theory which is 'grounded' in data that has been systematically collected and analysed.
- It is used to uncover such things as social relationships and behaviours of groups, known as **social processes**.
Using grounded theory, you can examine a specific process or phenomenon and develop new theories derived from the collected real-world data and their analysis

Importance of Incorporating Grounded Group Methodology in Qualitative Research

Grounded theory methodology is relevant for qualitative research as a whole in several ways:

- It has provided an integrated concept of how to do qualitative research.
- It has been a major input to the development of qualitative research as an approach and an alternative to other forms of social research.
- It has provided several tools for doing qualitative research, which can be used also in other contexts—like a specific conceptualization for the research process, for the sampling of materials, and for coding data and materials.
- Qualitative research using grounded theory was regarded as being ground-breaking upon its introduction. By using the **inductive methodology**, data (such as interviews and observations etc) could be analysed as they are being collected. They sought to move away from the dominant practice in the 1950s and 60s of starting with a theoretical framework which needed to be verified. They turned that practice on its head by starting with the data to develop theory.

Key Components

There are several distinguishing features of grounded theory.

1. **Inductive process:**

Grounded theory (GT) is conducted through an inductive process. This means that the researcher is developing theory rather than testing it and must therefore remain '**open**'



throughout the study. In essence, this means that the researcher has no preconceived ideas about the findings.

2. **Constant comparative analysis:**

Constant comparative analysis is an analytical process used in GT for coding and category development. This process commences with the first data generated or collected and fills the research process.

3. **Data Collection:**

A hallmark of GT is concurrent data generation/collection and analysis. In GT, researchers may utilize both qualitative and quantitative data. While interviews are a common method of generating data, data sources can include focus groups, questionnaires, surveys, transcripts, letters etc. Data is collected continuously till the required information is obtained.

4. **Theoretical Sampling:**

Theoretical sampling is a method in grounded theory to seek additional data based on concepts developed from initial data analysis. It is a way of generating explanatory theory from continuous comparative analysis of qualitative data. The researcher identifies a small number of people interviewed based on a set of criteria, then interviews them, and follows where the data have led to expand and refine the evolving theory.

5. **Coding:**

Coding is an analytical process used to identify concepts, similarities and conceptual recurrences in data. Coding is the pivotal link between collecting or generating data and developing a theory that explains the data. Data are broken down into smaller components and assigned a label to capture the essence of the data.

6. **Memos:**

Memos are a record of the researcher's ideas and thoughts during data collection and analysis. The use of memos helps to develop the researcher's analysis.

Steps of conducting grounded theory research

There are few steps of conducting grounded theory research which are given below:

1. **Finding a Problem:**

There can be several starting points for doing a grounded theory study, first one is researcher's **curiosity** which led them into taking something as a research problem for developing a grounded theory. A second **motivation** can be personal experience or concern. The third point of departure can be based on lacks and gaps in scientific research like **lack of theoretical models and theories**. The fourth one is the emergence of a new phenomenon or the **discovery of new problems**.

2. **Funding:**

The second step is problem of funding and research design and process in grounded theory. If the research needs some sort of **external approval for example-** approval by funding agency or by dissertation committee. In grounded research approval and elaborate





research design may be helpful. This design should include the number of participants and why the **individuals, groups, fields or institutions** are selected.

3. Research Ethics:

Although research ethics has become more important for qualitative research in general. Some ethics for grounded theory research are these;

- Methodological notes about how methods are applied and how to frame that situation.
- Theoretical notes in the sense of what grounded theory researchers describe as memos.
- Personal notes in the sense of a research diary or journal.

8. Analysis through Coding:

The central process in grounded theory research is **coding** the data. Coding means to **develop categories, properties** and relations among them. For coding researcher should be skillful and expert. There are three ways of coding;

- The starting point is always open coding sometimes called **initial coding**.
- The second one is **axial coding** or **focused coding** this can be include theoretical coding.
- Third one is **selective coding** which means that data are scan for more evidence or for core categories.

9. Developing a Theoretical Model:

By identifying structure and reducing the complexity through coding the theoretical model will be developed. Also, by following the above steps and guidelines for grounded theory research we can develop a good theoretical model.

Strengths and limitations of Grounded Theory Research

Strengths

1. Inductive Approach:

Grounded theory allows researchers to develop theories from the ground up, starting with raw data rather than imposing preconceived notions or hypotheses. For **example**, in a study on the experiences of first-time mothers, researchers may collect data through interviews and observations and then develop theories based on recurring themes and patterns in the data.

2. Flexibility:

Grounded theory is flexible and adaptable to various research contexts and disciplines. Researchers can modify their approach based on the evolving data and research objectives.

3. Rich and Detailed Findings:

Grounded theory often produces rich and detailed findings, providing insights into complex phenomena and uncovering underlying processes and relationships.

4. Validity and credibility:

Grounded theory has a strong emphasis on ensuring the validity and credibility of the findings. Through constant comparison and theoretical sampling, researchers can ensure that their theories accurately represent the data and capture the essence of the phenomenon.

5. Critical thinking:



Grounded theory has the potential to contribute to theory development in various fields. By generating theories directly from data, grounded theory can challenge and refine existing theories or propose entirely new ones. This methodology encourages researchers to think critically and creatively, pushing the boundaries of knowledge within their discipline.

Limitations:

1. Subjectivity:

Grounded theory relies heavily on the researcher's interpretation of the data, which can introduce subjectivity and bias. Researchers may inadvertently influence the analysis and interpretation of the data based on their own perspectives and assumptions.

2. Time-Consuming:

Grounded theory can be time-consuming and resource-intensive due to the iterative process of data collection, coding, and analysis. Researchers may need to spend significant amounts of time immersed in the data to identify patterns and develop theories.

3. Generalizability:

Grounded theory prioritizes depth over breadth, focusing on understanding specific contexts and phenomena in depth rather than aiming for generalizability. As a result, findings from grounded theory studies may not always be easily applicable to other settings or populations.

4. Ethical considerations:

Grounded theory research involving human participants raises ethical considerations that need to be carefully addressed. Researchers must ensure informed consent, protect participant anonymity and confidentiality, and consider potential harm or discomfort that may arise from participation. Ethical challenges may arise when dealing with sensitive topics or vulnerable populations, requiring researchers to navigate these complexities with care and sensitivity.

5. Complexity:

The methodology can be complex and challenging for novice researchers to understand and apply effectively, requiring a solid grasp of qualitative research principle.

Applications Of Grounded Theory Methodology

Following are some of the important applications of the grounded theory methodology.

1. In psychology, grounded theory is used to understand the role of **therapeutic** distance for adult clients with attachment anxiety.
2. Grounded theory is often used in **formulation of policies and program evaluation research**, since it can more effectively help in solving the unanswered questions. Grounded theory focuses more on procedures than on the discipline to which grounded theory is applied. Rather than being limited to a particular discipline or form of data collection, grounded theory has been found useful across multiple research areas.
3. **Public health** researchers have used grounded theory to examine nursing home preparedness needs in relation to Hurricane Katrina refugees sheltered in nursing homes.

4. In **business**, grounded theory is used by managers to explain the ways in which organizational characteristics explain co-worker support.
5. Grounded theory has also helped researchers in the field of **information technology** to study the use of computer technology in older adults.
6. In **nursing grounded** theory has been used to examine how change of shift can be used to keep patients safe. It was further developed in relation to students learning and working.
7. It provides explicit, sequential guidelines for conducting **qualitative research**.
8. It offers specific strategies for handling the analytic phases of **inquiry**.

Future Directions of Grounded Theory

In the past, grounded theory has often been viewed as separate from other methods. Now, the constructivist version makes the usefulness of combining grounded theory with other approaches more apparent, as is evident in grounded theory studies in **education**.

